

TERMS AND CONDITIONS OF LENIENT TREE

Last Updated: May 28, 2026

Welcome to Lenient Tree, a Proprietary concern (<https://www.lenienttree.com/>). These Terms and Conditions ("**Terms**") constitute a legally binding agreement made between you, whether personally or on behalf of an entity ("**you**", "**your**", or "**User**") and Lenient Tree ("**we**", "**us**", or "**our**"), concerning your access to and use of the Lenient Tree website, mobile applications, and any other online services or platforms provided by us (collectively, the "**Platform**").

Please read these Terms carefully before accessing or using our Platform. By accessing, browsing, registering an account, or using the Platform in any manner, you acknowledge that you have read, understood, and agree to be bound by all of these Terms and Conditions, as well as our Privacy Policy. These Terms set forth the legally binding terms for your use of the services, which include but are not limited to the aggregation and listing of hackathons, ideathons, webinars, and other technical events.

Your access to and use of the Platform is conditioned on your acceptance of and compliance with these Terms. These Terms apply to all visitors, users, and others who access or use the Platform. If you do not agree with all of these Terms and Conditions, then you are expressly prohibited from using the Platform and you must discontinue use immediately.

These Terms are effective as of May 28, 2026. We reserve the right, in our sole discretion, to make changes or modifications to these Terms at any time and for any reason. Your continued use of the Platform following the posting of any changes constitutes your acceptance of such changes. It is your responsibility to periodically review these Terms to stay informed of updates.

RECITALS

Lenient Tree operates a specialized online platform and digital aggregator located at <https://www.lenienttree.com/> designed to facilitate, host, and list a variety of technology-driven events, including but not limited to hackathons, ideathons, webinars, and conclaves.

The Platform serves as a centralized ecosystem intended to connect tech enthusiasts, students, and professionals with opportunities for skill development, networking, and innovation hosted by various third-party entities, academic institutions, and corporate sponsors.

The User desires to access and utilize the Platform for the purposes of discovering events, managing registrations, maintaining digital portfolios, and accessing certificate galleries, subject to the terms and conditions set forth herein.

Lenient Tree acts as an intermediary and digital infrastructure provider, seeking to streamline the interaction between event organizers and participants while maintaining the integrity and security of the digital environment.

These Recitals set forth the background and context for the contractual relationship between Lenient Tree and the User, and the parties agree that the following terms and conditions shall govern all aspects of the User's access to and engagement with the Platform within the jurisdiction of Ernakulam, Kerala.

1. DEFINITIONS

1.1 Agreement

Agreement refers to these Terms and Conditions, the Privacy Policy, and all other operating rules, policies, and procedures that may be published from time to time on the Platform by Lenient Tree.

1.2 Content

Content means all information and data, including but not limited to text, software, scripts, graphics, photos, sounds, music, videos, interactive features, and trademarks, whether produced by Lenient Tree or licensed from third parties, accessible via the Platform.

1.3 Events

Events refers to the hackathons, ideathons, webinars, conclaves, workshops, technical competitions, and other professional or educational gatherings that are listed, aggregated, or hosted on the Platform.

1.4 Platform

Platform refers to the Lenient Tree website (<https://www.lenienttree.com/>), mobile applications, and any other online services, tools, or digital interfaces owned and operated by Lenient Tree.

1.5 Services

Services encompasses the full suite of digital offerings provided by Lenient Tree, including but not limited to event aggregation, account registration, certificate gallery hosting, event calendar management, and participant communication tools.

1.6 Third-Party Event Organizers

Third-Party Event Organizers refers to the external entities, including academic institutions, student chapters, non-profit organizations, or corporate sponsors, who utilize the Platform to promote, manage, or host their specific Events.

1.7 **User**

User (also referred to as "**you**" or "**your**") refers to any individual, person, or legal entity who accesses, browses, or registers an account on the Platform, including participants, developers, and event organizers.

1.8 **User Content**

User Content means any materials, including but not limited to project source code, portfolios, text, images, profile data, and feedback, that are uploaded, posted, or otherwise submitted to the Platform by a User.

1.9 **Data Fiduciary**

Data Fiduciary refers to Lenient Tree, which, alone or in conjunction with other persons, determines the purpose and means of processing Personal Data under the Digital Personal Data Protection Act, 2023.

1.10 **Data Principal**

Data Principal refers to the User, being the individual to whom the Personal Data relates.

1.11 **Personal Data**

Personal Data means any data about an individual who is identifiable by or in relation to such data, as defined under the Digital Personal Data Protection Act, 2023.

2. **ELIGIBILITY AND ACCOUNT REGISTRATION**

2.1 **Age of Majority and Verifiable Consent**

Access to and use of the Platform is restricted to individuals who are at least 18 years of age. By using this Platform, you represent and warrant that you satisfy this age requirement. If you are under the age of 18 (a "**Child**" under Indian Law), you represent that you have obtained the verifiable consent of your parent or lawful guardian to access the Platform and that such parent or guardian has agreed to be bound by these Terms on your behalf. Any registration by, use of, or access to the Platform by anyone under 18 without verifiable parental consent is unauthorized and in violation of these Terms.

2.2 **Account Creation and Registration**

To access certain specialized features of the Platform, including but not limited to registering for hackathons (such as LenientHack), creating an event calendar, or hosting certificate galleries, you must register for an account. You agree to provide true, accurate, current, and complete information as prompted by the Platform's registration process. You further agree to maintain and promptly update your registration data to keep it true, accurate, current, and complete at all times.

2.3 **Account Security and Confidentiality**

You are solely responsible for maintaining the confidentiality of your account credentials, including your username and password. You acknowledge and agree that you are fully responsible for all activities that occur under your account. You must implement reasonable security measures to prevent unauthorized access to your account and must not disclose your password to any third party.

2.4 **Notification of Unauthorized Use**

You agree to notify Lenient Tree immediately of any unauthorized use of your account or any other breach of security of which you become aware. Lenient Tree shall not be liable for any loss or damage arising from your failure to comply with this Section 2.4 or for any unauthorized access to your account resulting from your own negligence or act of omission.

2.5 Responsibility for Minor Users

In the event that a parent or legal guardian permits a minor to use the Platform via their account or by consenting to the minor's account creation, such parent or guardian shall be held fully responsible for: (i) the online conduct of such minor; (ii) monitoring such minor's access to and use of the Platform; and (iii) the consequences of any misuse of the Platform by such minor.

2.6 Right to Suspend or Terminate

Lenient Tree reserves the right to suspend, disable, or terminate your account at its sole discretion and without prior notice if it determines that you have provided false or misleading information, or if your conduct violates any provision of these Terms or any applicable laws of India. Upon termination, your right to use the Platform will cease immediately.

3. PLATFORM SERVICES AND ROLES

3.1 Event Aggregator and Listing Services

The Platform functions as a digital ecosystem and centralized hub designed to aggregate, host, and list various technology-related events, including but not limited to hackathons, ideathons, webinars, technical conclaves, and workshops (collectively, "Events"). Lenient Tree provides the digital infrastructure for Event discovery, information dissemination, and user engagement.

3.2 **Facilitator Status**

Lenient Tree acts solely as a facilitator and intermediary platform. The provision of the Platform does not constitute an endorsement of any third-party Event or organizer. Unless explicitly designated as a "**Lenient Tree Proprietary Event**," all Events are managed by external entities independent of the Platform.

3.3 **Third-Party Event Management**

A significant portion of Events listed on the Platform are organized, managed, and hosted by independent third parties, including but not limited to academic institutions, campus groups, student chapters, and corporate sponsors.

3.3.1 Lenient Tree exercises no editorial or operational control over third-party Events and is not responsible for their logistical execution, content quality, curriculum, or technical requirements.

3.3.2 The scheduling, venue (whether physical or virtual), entry requirements, and specific rules of engagement for such Events are determined exclusively by the respective third-party organizers.

3.4 **Provision of Platform Utilities**

To support Event participation, Lenient Tree offers various services, including but not limited to account dashboards, event calendars, registration tracking, and hosting for certificate galleries and project portfolios. These services are provided to facilitate the interaction between users and organizers but do not transfer responsibility for the Event itself to Lenient Tree.

3.5 Disclaimer of Event Liability

Lenient Tree disclaims all liability for any loss, damage, or injury resulting from participation in any Event listed on the Platform. The User acknowledges that any engagement with an Event organizer is an independent arrangement to which Lenient Tree is not a party, and any disputes regarding Event delivery must be settled directly with the organizer.

3.6 Accuracy of Event Information

While Lenient Tree encourages organizers to provide accurate information, it does not warrant that the descriptions, dates, or terms of any Event are current or error-free. Users are advised to verify critical details with the specific Event organizers before making commitments or relying on the information provided on the Platform.

4. USER CONDUCT AND PROHIBITED ACTIVITIES

4.1 Compliance with Laws and Regulations

You shall utilize the Platform only for lawful purposes and in strict accordance with these Terms. You agree to comply with all applicable local, state, national, and international laws, including but not limited to the Information Technology Act, 2000, and the Digital Personal Data Protection Act, 2023, along with any other regulations applicable within the jurisdiction of Ernakulam, Kerala, and India.

4.2 Restrictions on User Content

You are prohibited from posting, uploading, transmitting, or otherwise making available any content that:

- 4.2.1 Is defamatory, obscene, pornographic, pedophilic, invasive of another's privacy, or libelous under Indian law.
- 4.2.2 Harasses or advocates harassment of another person or group based on religion, race, gender, caste, or disability.
- 4.2.3 Infringes upon the intellectual property rights, including patents, trademarks, trade secrets, or copyrights, of Lenient Tree or any third party.
- 4.2.4 Contains software viruses, Trojan horses, or any other computer code designed to interrupt, destroy, or limit the functionality of any computer resource.

4.3 **Fair Play and Academic Integrity**

In the context of participating in Events such as hackathons, ideathons, or technical competitions hosted or aggregated on the Platform, you agree to maintain the highest standards of professional and academic integrity.

- 4.3.1 You shall not engage in plagiarism, which includes the submission of pre-existing code, projects, or designs as original work unless such use is expressly permitted by the specific Event rules.
- 4.3.2 You shall not engage in cheating, collusion, or any unfair practice designed to gain an undue advantage over other participants or to manipulate the outcome of an Event.
- 4.3.3 Any violation of specific Event rules or the Code of Conduct provided by an organizer shall be deemed a material breach of these Terms.

4.4 **Automated Access and Scraping**

The use of any automated system, including without limitation "**robots**," "**spiders**," "**offline readers**," or "**scrapers**," to access, monitor, or copy content from the Platform for any purpose without the express prior written permission of Lenient Tree is strictly prohibited. You shall not harvest or collect any personally identifiable information, including account names or email addresses, from the Platform.

4.5 **Interference and Disruptive Acts**

You agree not to engage in any activity that interferes with or disrupts the operation of the Platform. Specifically, you shall not:

- 4.5.1 Circumvent, disable, or otherwise interfere with security-related features of the Platform or features that prevent or restrict the use or copying of any content.
- 4.5.2 Attempt to gain unauthorized access to any portion of the Platform, other user accounts, or any systems or networks connected to Lenient Tree through hacking, password mining, or any other means.
- 4.5.3 Take any action that imposes, or may impose at our sole discretion, an unreasonable or disproportionately large load on our infrastructure or the bandwidth of our service providers.
- 4.5.4 Use the Platform to transmit "**junk mail**," "**chain letters**," unsolicited "**spam**," or any other form of unauthorized solicitation.

4.6 **Reporting Violations**

Users are encouraged to report any behavior that violates this Section 4 to Lenient Tree. We reserve the right, but not the obligation, to monitor user activity and to

remove any content or suspend any account that we, in our sole discretion, deem to be in violation of these standards.

5. USER-GENERATED CONTENT AND INTELLECTUAL PROPERTY

5.1 Ownership of User Content

You retain all proprietary rights, including copyright and other intellectual property rights, in and to the project code, portfolios, text, images, profiles, and other materials you upload, post, or display on the Platform ("**User Content**"). Lenient Tree does not claim ownership over your original User Content.

5.2 License Grant to the Platform

By submitting User Content to the Platform, you hereby grant Lenient Tree a perpetual, irrevocable, worldwide, non-exclusive, royalty-free, sub-licensable, and transferable license to use, reproduce, distribute, display, perform, modify, and create derivative works of your User Content. This license is granted solely for the purposes of operating, providing, promoting, marketing, and improving the Platform and its associated services in any media formats and through any media channels.

5.3 User Warranties and Representations

You represent and warrant that you possess all necessary rights, licenses, and permissions to grant the licenses mentioned in Clause 5.2 and that your User Content does not infringe upon the intellectual property, privacy, or publicity rights of any third party. You agree to bear all responsibility for any legal consequences or claims arising from the content you provide.

5.4 Platform Intellectual Property Rights

All content, materials, and features available on the Platform, including but not limited to the user interface, website design, graphics, source code, images, logos, software, and structural elements, are the exclusive intellectual property of Lenient Tree and are protected by the Copyright Act, 1957, the Trade Marks Act, 1999, and other applicable intellectual property laws of India.

5.5 **Prohibited Use of Branding**

Nothing in these Terms shall be construed as granting you any right or license to use the name "**Lenient Tree**," its logos, trademarks, domain names, or service marks for any commercial or non-commercial purpose without the express prior written consent of Lenient Tree. Any unauthorized use of the Platform's branding constitutes an infringement of our intellectual property rights and may lead to legal action in the courts of Ernakulam, Kerala.

5.6 **Feedback and Suggestions**

In the event you provide any suggestions, comments, or feedback regarding the functionality or features of the Platform ("**Feedback**"), you agree that such Feedback is provided voluntarily. You hereby grant Lenient Tree an unrestricted, perpetual, and royalty-free license to use, disclose, and incorporate such Feedback into the Platform or any other services without any obligation of confidentiality, compensation, or accounting to you.

6. **EVENT PARTICIPATION, SPONSORSHIPS, AND PRIZES**

6.1 **Registration and Compliance**

By registering for or participating in any hackathons, ideathons, webinars, conclaves, or other tech-related events (collectively, "**Events**") listed on the Platform, you expressly agree to abide by the specific rules, guidelines, eligibility criteria, and code

of conduct established by the respective Event organizers. Your participation is contingent upon your continued compliance with both these Terms and the specific regulations governing the individual Event.

6.2 Role of Lenient Tree

You acknowledge and agree that Lenient Tree acts primarily as a digital hub and aggregator for Events. Unless explicitly stated otherwise in writing by Lenient Tree, the Platform is not the organizer, primary sponsor, or host of the Events listed. Consequently, Lenient Tree does not exercise editorial or operational control over third-party Events.

6.3 Prizes, Rewards, and Grants

6.3.1 Sponsorship Obligations

Any prizes, rewards, grants, scholarships, certificates, or other incentives promised in connection with an Event are provided and fulfilled exclusively by the third-party organizers, academic institutions, or corporate sponsors associated with that specific Event.

6.3.2 Fulfillment and Delivery

The responsibility for the selection of winners, the distribution of awards, and the quality, legality, and physical or digital fulfillment of such rewards rests solely with the designated organizers or sponsors. Lenient Tree does not guarantee the accuracy of prize descriptions or the ultimate delivery of any promised reward.

6.4 Disclaimer of Liability

Lenient Tree, its founders, and affiliates hereby disclaim any and all liability, whether in contract, tort, or otherwise, arising from:

- 6.4.1 The cancellation, postponement, or material modification of any Event by a third-party organizer.
- 6.4.2 Any disputes regarding the judging process, scoring, or selection criteria used by Event organizers to determine winners.
- 6.4.3 Any failure, delay, or refusal by a third-party organizer or sponsor to honor or deliver promised prizes, certificates, or financial grants.

6.5 **Dispute Resolution with Organizers**

In the event of a dispute regarding participation terms, technical issues during an Event, or the non-receipt of prizes, you agree to seek recourse directly from the respective Event organizer or sponsor. Lenient Tree shall have no obligation to mediate, intervene, or participate in any disputes between users and third-party organizers.

7. **DISCLAIMER OF WARRANTIES**

7.1 **"As Is" and "As Available" Basis**

The Platform, including all content, software, functions, materials, and information made available on or accessed through the Platform, is provided to the User on an **"as is"** and **"as available"** basis. To the fullest extent permissible by law, Lenient Tree makes no representations or warranties of any kind whatsoever for the content on the Platform or the materials, information, and functions made accessible by the software used on or accessed through the Platform.

7.2 Exclusion of Implied Warranties

Lenient Tree hereby disclaims all warranties, whether express, implied, statutory, or otherwise, including but not limited to:

- 7.2.1 Any warranties of merchantability, fitness for a particular purpose, title, and non-infringement;
- 7.2.2 Any warranties arising out of the course of dealing, usage, or trade; and
- 7.2.3 Any warranties that the Platform or the results of the use thereof will meet the User's requirements, achieve any intended results, be compatible, or work with any other software, applications, systems, or services.

7.3 Operational Performance and Accuracy

Lenient Tree does not warrant that the functions contained in the Platform or any materials or content contained therein will be uninterrupted, timely, secure, or error-free, that defects will be corrected, or that the Platform or the server that makes it available is free of viruses or other harmful components. Lenient Tree does not warrant or make any representations regarding the use or the results of the use of the materials on the Platform in terms of their correctness, accuracy, reliability, or otherwise.

7.4 Third-Party Content and Event Data

As a digital aggregator of Events, Lenient Tree provides information sourced from third-party organizers, academic institutions, and corporate sponsors. Lenient Tree does not warrant the accuracy, completeness, legality, or usefulness of any information regarding hackathons, ideathons, webinars, or other Events organized by third parties. Any reliance the User places on such information is strictly at their own risk.

7.5 Security and Data Integrity

While Lenient Tree employs standard security measures, it cannot and does not guarantee that the Platform will be immune from unauthorized access, hacking, data loss, or other security breaches. The User is responsible for implementing sufficient procedures and checkpoints to satisfy their particular requirements for anti-virus protection and accuracy of data input and output.

7.6 No Oral Advice

No advice or information, whether oral or written, obtained by the User from Lenient Tree or through or from the Platform shall create any warranty not expressly stated in these Terms. The User's use of the Platform and any content downloaded or otherwise obtained through the use of the Platform is at the User's own discretion and risk.

8. LIMITATION OF LIABILITY

8.1 Exclusion of Indirect Damages

To the maximum extent permitted by applicable law in the jurisdiction of Ernakulam, Kerala, in no event shall Lenient Tree, its founders, directors, employees, or agents be liable for any indirect, incidental, special, consequential, or punitive damages, including but not limited to loss of profits, revenue, data, use, goodwill, or other intangible losses, resulting from (i) your access to or use of or inability to access or use the Platform; (ii) any conduct or content of any third party on the Platform; (iii) any content obtained from the Platform; and (iv) unauthorized access, use, or alteration of your transmissions or content.

8.2 Basis of Liability

The limitations of liability set forth in this Section 8 shall apply regardless of whether the claim is based on warranty, contract, tort (including negligence), strict liability, or any other legal theory, and whether or not Lenient Tree has been informed of the possibility of such damage, and even if a remedy set forth herein is found to have failed of its essential purpose.

8.3 Service Disruptions and Technical Failures

Lenient Tree shall not be held liable for any loss or damage arising from:

- 8.3.1 any errors, mistakes, or inaccuracies of content displayed on the Platform;
- 8.3.2 personal injury or property damage, of any nature whatsoever, resulting from your access to and use of our Platform;
- 8.3.3 any unauthorized access to or use of our secure servers and/or any and all personal information stored therein;
- 8.3.4 any interruption or cessation of transmission to or from our Platform;
- 8.3.5 any bugs, viruses, trojan horses, or the like that may be transmitted to or through our Platform by any third party.

8.4 Liability for Third-Party Events and Prizes

As an aggregator and facilitator, Lenient Tree disclaims all liability regarding the execution, safety, scheduling, or legality of Events organized by third parties. Any claims arising from participation in such Events, including the non-delivery or quality

of prizes, grants, or certificates, must be directed solely to the respective third-party organizer.

8.5 **Aggregate Liability Cap**

In no event shall the total aggregate liability of Lenient Tree for all claims relating to the use of the Platform exceed the amount of INR 1,000 (Rupees One Thousand Only) or the total amount paid by the User to Lenient Tree for the specific services in question during the three (3) months preceding the claim, whichever is lower.

8.6 **Statutory Rights**

Nothing in these Terms is intended to exclude or limit any condition, warranty, right, or liability which may not be lawfully excluded or limited under the laws of India. Some jurisdictions do not allow the exclusion of certain warranties or the limitation or exclusion of liability for loss or damage caused by negligence, breach of contract, or breach of implied terms, or incidental or consequential damages. Accordingly, only the limitations which are lawful in your jurisdiction will apply to you and our liability will be limited to the maximum extent permitted by law.

9. **INDEMNIFICATION**

9.1 **Obligation to Indemnify**

You agree to defend, indemnify, and hold harmless Lenient Tree, its founders, directors, officers, employees, agents, subsidiaries, affiliates, and licensors (collectively, the "**Indemnified Parties**") from and against any and all claims, actions, suits, demands, liabilities, damages, losses, costs, and expenses, including but not limited to reasonable attorney fees and court costs, arising out of or in any way connected with the events described in Clause 9.2.

9.2 Scope of Indemnification

The indemnification obligations set forth in Clause 9.1 shall apply to any claim arising from or related to:

- 9.2.1 your access to, use of, or misuse of the Platform, Services, or any content provided therein;
- 9.2.2 any User Content, project code, or personal data you upload, post, store, or otherwise transmit through the Platform, including claims that such content infringes upon the intellectual property, privacy, or proprietary rights of any third party;
- 9.2.3 your breach or alleged breach of any provision of these Terms and Conditions, or any violation of the representations and warranties made by you herein;
- 9.2.4 your violation of any applicable local, state, national, or international laws, rules, or regulations, including but not limited to the Information Technology Act, 2000, and the Digital Personal Data Protection Act, 2023;
- 9.2.5 your conduct, participation, or disputes in connection with any hackathon, ideathon, webinar, or other Event organized or hosted via the Platform.

9.3 Defense and Cooperation

Lenient Tree reserves the right, at its own expense and discretion, to assume the exclusive defense and control of any matter otherwise subject to indemnification by you. In such an event, you agree to cooperate fully with Lenient Tree in asserting any available defenses and providing all necessary documentation or testimony required for the resolution of the claim.

9.4 Settlement of Claims

You shall not, in any event, settle any claim, suit, or legal action that involves a potential liability or admission of fault on the part of Lenient Tree without our prior written consent. Lenient Tree shall not be liable for any settlement made without its express written approval.

9.5 Survival of Obligations

The indemnification and hold harmless obligations contained in this Section 9 shall survive the termination or expiration of your account, these Terms, and your use of the Platform, remaining in full force and effect regarding any acts or omissions occurring during the term of your usage.

10. MODIFICATIONS TO THE TERMS AND SERVICE

10.1 Right to Amend Terms

Lenient Tree reserves the right, at its sole and absolute discretion, to update, change, modify, add, or remove any portion of these Terms and Conditions at any time. Such amendments may be necessitated by changes in applicable laws, regulatory requirements, technological advancements, or modifications to our business practices and service offerings within the jurisdiction of India.

10.2 Notification and Effectiveness

Any modifications to these Terms shall be effective immediately upon being posted on the Platform. The "**Last Updated**" date displayed at the top of these Terms shall serve as the primary indicator of the most recent revisions. While Lenient Tree may, at its discretion, provide additional notification of material changes through electronic

mail or platform-wide announcements, it remains the sole responsibility of the User to review these Terms periodically for updates.

10.3 Acceptance through Continued Use

Your continued access to or use of the Platform following the posting of any changes to these Terms constitutes your unconditional and irrevocable acceptance of those changes. If you do not agree to the modified Terms, your sole and exclusive remedy is to immediately cease all use of the Platform and, where applicable, deactivate your registered account.

10.4 Modification and Discontinuation of Services

Lenient Tree reserves the right to modify, enhance, restrict, suspend, or discontinue, temporarily or permanently, any part of the Platform or its associated services at any time without prior notice or liability. This includes, without limitation:

- 10.4.1 The modification or removal of specific features, functionalities, or services offered through the Platform;
- 10.4.2 The adjustment of technical specifications, access protocols, or security measures; and
- 10.4.3 The total cessation of Platform operations for maintenance, security upgrades, or strategic business reasons.

10.5 No Liability for Service Changes

The User acknowledges and agrees that Lenient Tree, its founders, and its affiliates shall not be liable to the User or any third party for any modification, suspension, or

discontinuation of the Platform or any part thereof, including any loss of user-generated data or disruption of participation in Events resulting from such changes.

11. PRIVACY POLICY

11.1 Data Fiduciary and DPDPA Compliance

Lenient Tree acts as a Data Fiduciary and processes Personal Data in strict compliance with the Digital Personal Data Protection Act, 2023 ("**DPDPA**"). Our Privacy Policy, which is incorporated herein by reference, outlines the specific details of data processing, storage, and protection.

11.2 Notice and Specified Purpose

Lenient Tree shall provide notice to the Data Principal at or before the time of seeking consent, detailing the Personal Data to be collected and the specific purpose for which such data will be processed. Personal Data is processed primarily to facilitate Event discovery, registration management, and digital portfolio hosting.

11.3 Consent and Withdrawal

By using the Platform, you grant free, specific, informed, unconditional, and unambiguous consent to the processing of your Personal Data for the purposes specified. You shall have the right to withdraw your consent at any time through the account settings or by contacting the Grievance Officer. Upon withdrawal, Lenient Tree shall cease processing your Personal Data within a reasonable timeframe, unless required by law.

11.4 Rights of the Data Principal

In accordance with the DPDPA, every User as a Data Principal has the right to: (i) access information about their Personal Data being processed; (ii) seek correction, completion, or erasure of their Personal Data; (iii) seek grievance redressal; and (iv) nominate any other individual to exercise these rights in the event of death or incapacity.

11.5 Data Fiduciary Obligations and Security

Lenient Tree implements appropriate technical and organizational measures to ensure effective compliance with the DPDPA and to protect Personal Data from unauthorized access or breach. In the event of a Personal Data breach, Lenient Tree shall notify the Data Protection Board of India and the affected Data Principals as required by law.

11.6 Duties of the Data Principal

Users must ensure that they do not: (i) suppress any material information while providing Personal Data; (ii) impersonate another person; or (iii) register any false or frivolous grievances with the Grievance Officer or the Data Protection Board of India.

11.7 Data Storage and Deletion

Lenient Tree shall retain Personal Data only for as long as is necessary to satisfy the specified purpose or as required by any applicable laws of India. Once the purpose is served and retention is no longer necessary for legal or business purposes, the data shall be erased.

12. THIRD-PARTY LINKS

12.1 External Links and Third-Party Services

The Platform may contain hypertext links to websites, applications, or services owned and operated by third parties, including but not limited to academic institutions, event organizers, corporate sponsors, and advertisers ("**Third-Party Links**"). These Third-Party Links are provided solely for your convenience and for informational purposes.

12.2 No Control or Endorsement

Lenient Tree does not exercise any control over, and assumes no responsibility for, the content, privacy policies, or practices of any third-party websites or services. The inclusion of any Third-Party Link on the Platform does not imply an endorsement, approval, sponsorship, or recommendation by Lenient Tree of the third party or its offerings.

12.3 Disclaimer of Liability

To the maximum extent permitted by law, Lenient Tree shall not be held liable, directly or indirectly, for any damage or loss caused or alleged to be caused by or in connection with the use of or reliance on any such content, goods, or services available on or through any such third-party websites or services. This disclaimer includes, but is not limited to:

12.3.1 The accuracy, reliability, or quality of any information provided on third-party sites.

12.3.2 Any technical issues, malware, or viruses encountered while visiting external platforms.

12.3.3 Any financial transactions or data exchanges conducted between you and a third-party provider.

12.4 User Responsibility and Caution

You acknowledge and agree that your access to and use of Third-Party Links is at your own risk. We strongly encourage you to review the terms and conditions and privacy policies of any third-party website or service that you visit, as your interactions with them are governed strictly by their own legal frameworks and not by these Terms.

12.5 Reporting Broken Links

While Lenient Tree is not responsible for external content, if you discover a link on our Platform that you believe to be inappropriate, broken, or in violation of these Terms, you may contact us to request its removal. However, Lenient Tree is under no legal obligation to comply with such requests or to provide a response.

13. SEVERABILITY

13.1 Validity of Remaining Provisions

If any provision of these Terms, or any part thereof, is held by a court of competent jurisdiction or an administrative authority in Ernakulam, Kerala, to be invalid, illegal, or unenforceable under any applicable law, such invalidity, illegality, or unenforceability shall not affect the other provisions of these Terms. The remaining provisions shall remain in full force and effect as if the invalid, illegal, or unenforceable part had never been included.

13.2 Preservation of Intent

In the event that any provision is found to be invalid or unenforceable, the parties agree that the court or authority should endeavor to give effect to the parties' intentions as reflected in the provision. To this end, such provision shall be deemed modified or replaced by a valid and enforceable provision that most closely approximates the economic and legal intent of the original provision.

13.3 Non-Impairment of Agreement

The invalidity or unenforceability of any provision in any specific jurisdiction shall not affect the validity or enforceability of such provision in any other jurisdiction, nor shall it affect the validity or enforceability of any other provision of these Terms. Each clause and sub-clause of these Terms is intended to be severable and distinct.

13.4 Scope of Application

If a court finds that any provision of these Terms is invalid or unenforceable, but that by limiting such provision it would become valid and enforceable, then such provision shall be deemed to be written, construed, and enforced as so limited to the maximum extent permitted by the laws of India and the local regulations applicable in the State of Kerala.

14. ENTIRE AGREEMENT

14.1 Comprehensive Agreement

These Terms and Conditions, together with the Privacy Policy and any other legal notices or guidelines published by Lenient Tree on the Platform, constitute the entire and integrated agreement between the User and Lenient Tree regarding the access to and use of the Platform. This instrument contains the final and complete expression of the parties' agreement.

14.2 Supersession of Prior Understandings

This Agreement supersedes and replaces all prior or contemporaneous communications, representations, warranties, negotiations, and understandings, whether electronic, oral, or written, between the User and Lenient Tree with respect to

the Platform, including but not limited to any previous versions of these Terms and Conditions.

14.3 No Reliance

The User acknowledges and agrees that in entering into these Terms, they have not relied upon any statement, representation, warranty, or understanding (whether made negligently or innocently) of any person (whether party to these Terms or not) other than as expressly set out in these Terms or the incorporated Privacy Policy.

14.4 Integration of Supplemental Terms

Notwithstanding the foregoing, certain features or services of the Platform (such as participation in LenientHack or other specific Events) may be subject to additional rules, guidelines, or codes of conduct. The User agrees that any such supplemental terms shall be considered part of this entire agreement, provided that in the event of an irreconcilable conflict, the provisions of these Terms and Conditions shall prevail unless the supplemental terms specifically state otherwise.

14.5 Modifications and Amendments

No variation, modification, or amendment of these Terms shall be valid or binding unless it is made in writing and posted on the Platform by Lenient Tree in accordance with Section 10, or is otherwise executed in a formal written instrument signed by an authorized signatory of Lenient Tree.

15. WAIVER

15.1 No Implied Waiver

The failure or delay of Lenient Tree to exercise or enforce any right, power, or remedy provided under these Terms and Conditions or by law shall not constitute a waiver of that or any other right or remedy, nor shall it prevent or restrict the further exercise of that or any other right or remedy. No single or partial exercise of such right or remedy shall prevent or restrict the further exercise of that or any other right or remedy.

15.2 Written Requirement

A waiver of any right or provision under these Terms shall only be effective if it is in writing and signed by a duly authorized representative of Lenient Tree. Any such waiver shall apply only to the specific instance and for the specific purpose for which it is given and shall not be deemed a waiver of any subsequent breach or default.

15.3 Continuance of Obligations

Unless expressly stated otherwise in a written waiver signed by Lenient Tree, no indulgence or concession granted by Lenient Tree to a User shall alter, prejudice, or affect the rights of Lenient Tree under these Terms, nor shall it be construed as a waiver of Lenient Tree's right to insist upon strict performance of the User's obligations in the future.

15.4 Remedies Cumulative

The rights and remedies of Lenient Tree under these Terms are cumulative and are not exclusive of any rights or remedies provided by law or equity in the jurisdiction of Ernakulam, Kerala, or any other applicable jurisdiction.

16. ASSIGNMENT

16.1 Non-Assignment by the User

The User shall not assign, delegate, sub-license, or otherwise transfer any of their rights, duties, or obligations under these Terms, whether by operation of law or otherwise, to any third party without the prior express written consent of Lenient Tree. Any attempt by the User to assign or transfer these Terms without such consent shall be null, void, and of no legal effect.

16.2 Assignment by Lenient Tree

Lenient Tree reserves the right to assign, transfer, or delegate its rights and obligations under these Terms, in whole or in part, at its sole discretion and without providing prior notice to or obtaining consent from the User. Such assignment may occur, without limitation, in the event of a merger, acquisition, corporate reorganization, sale of all or substantially all of its assets, or to any affiliate or successor entity.

16.3 Successors and Assigns

Subject to the restrictions on assignment set forth herein, these Terms and the rights and obligations of the parties hereunder shall be binding upon and inure to the benefit of the parties and their respective successors, heirs, legal representatives, and permitted assigns.

16.4 Unauthorized Transfers

Any purported assignment or delegation in violation of this Section 16 shall be deemed a material breach of these Terms, and Lenient Tree may, at its option, terminate the User's account and access to the Platform immediately without further liability.

17. FORCE MAJEURE

17.1 Definition of Force Majeure Event

A "**Force Majeure Event**" shall mean any event or circumstance, or combination of events and circumstances, that is beyond the reasonable control of Lenient Tree, which prevents or delays Lenient Tree from performing any of its obligations under these Terms. Such events include, but are not limited to:

- 17.1.1 acts of God, such as fire, flood, earthquake, windstorm, or other natural disasters;
- 17.1.2 war, hostilities (whether war be declared or not), invasion, act of foreign enemies, mobilization, requisition, or embargo;
- 17.1.3 rebellion, revolution, insurrection, military or usurped power, or civil war;
- 17.1.4 acts of terrorism, civil commotion, or riots;
- 17.1.5 any law, order, rule, or regulation of any government or public authority, including but not limited to lockdowns, quarantines, or restrictions on movement and business operations;
- 17.1.6 nuclear, chemical, or biological contamination or sonic boom;
- 17.1.7 epidemic, pandemic, or public health emergencies (including but not limited to COVID-19 or any mutation thereof);
- 17.1.8 labor or trade disputes, strikes, industrial action, or lockouts involving third-party service providers;
- 17.1.9 widespread disruption of public infrastructure, including interruption or failure of utility services such as electricity, telecommunications, or internet connectivity; and

17.1.10 cyber-attacks, distributed denial-of-service (DDoS) attacks, or other malicious activities by third parties that compromise the integrity or availability of the Platform.

17.2 Exclusion of Liability

Lenient Tree shall not be held liable or responsible to the User, nor be deemed to have defaulted under or breached these Terms, for any failure or delay in fulfilling or performing any obligation under these Terms when and to the extent such failure or delay is caused by or results from a Force Majeure Event.

17.3 Suspension of Obligations

In the occurrence of a Force Majeure Event, the performance of Lenient Tree's obligations shall be suspended for the duration of the Force Majeure Event. The time for performance of such obligations shall be extended by a period equal to the duration of the delay caused by the event. Lenient Tree shall use commercially reasonable efforts to mitigate the effects of the Force Majeure Event and to resume performance of its obligations as soon as practicable.

17.4 Right to Discontinue

If the Force Majeure Event continues for a continuous period of more than sixty (60) days, Lenient Tree may, at its sole discretion and without any liability to the User, elect to suspend, discontinue, or terminate the Platform or any specific Services affected by the Force Majeure Event by providing notice on the website or via registered email.

18. GOVERNING LAW AND JURISDICTION

18.1 Governing Law

These Terms and Conditions, and all matters arising out of or relating to these Terms, shall be governed by and construed in accordance with the laws of the Republic of India, without giving effect to any principles of conflicts of law that would require the application of the laws of any other jurisdiction.

18.2 Exclusive Jurisdiction

In the event of any dispute, controversy, or claim arising out of or relating to these Terms, including the interpretation, breach, termination, or validity thereof, the parties agree to submit to the exclusive jurisdiction of the courts located in Ernakulam, Kerala, India. You hereby waive any and all objections to the exercise of jurisdiction over you by such courts and to venue in such courts.

18.3 Legal Compliance and International Use

Lenient Tree operates and controls the Platform from its offices within India. Although the Platform may be accessible worldwide, we make no representation that the Platform or the materials therein are appropriate or available for use in locations outside of India. Users who choose to access the Platform from other jurisdictions do so on their own initiative and are solely responsible for compliance with applicable local laws.

18.4 Waiver of Jury Trial and Class Action

To the extent permitted by applicable law, you and Lenient Tree agree that any proceedings to resolve or litigate any dispute will be conducted solely on an individual basis and not in a class, collective, or representative action. You further waive any right to a jury trial in any proceeding arising out of these Terms.

19. CONTACT INFORMATION

19.1 General Inquiries

For any questions, feedback, or general inquiries regarding these Terms and Conditions or the Platform, users may contact Lenient Tree through our designated electronic communication channel. All such inquiries should be directed to our support team at the following email address: support@lenienttree.com.

19.2 Official Notices

All formal legal notices or official correspondence directed to Lenient Tree must be sent in writing to our registered office address in Ernakulam. Notices shall be deemed sufficiently served when delivered by hand, by registered post with acknowledgment due, or by a recognized international courier service to:

Lenient Tree

[Insert Official Registered Address]

Ernakulam, Kerala, India.

19.3 DPDPA Grievance Redressal

In compliance with the Digital Personal Data Protection Act, 2023, and the Information Technology Act, 2000, any grievances or complaints regarding data processing or the Platform shall be directed to the Grievance Officer. We are committed to responding to your grievance within the statutory timelines prescribed under the DPDPA. The Grievance Officer can be reached at the email address specified in clause 19.1 with the subject line "**Attn: DPDPA Grievance Officer**".

19.4 Electronic Communications

By using the Platform, you consent to receive communications from us electronically, such as via email or through notices posted on the Platform. You agree that all agreements, notices, disclosures, and other communications that we provide to you electronically satisfy any legal requirement that such communications be in writing.

Lenient Tree (<https://www.lenienttree.com/>).